

Reduce Access Attack Surface Through Just-in-Time and Just-Enough Privileged Access

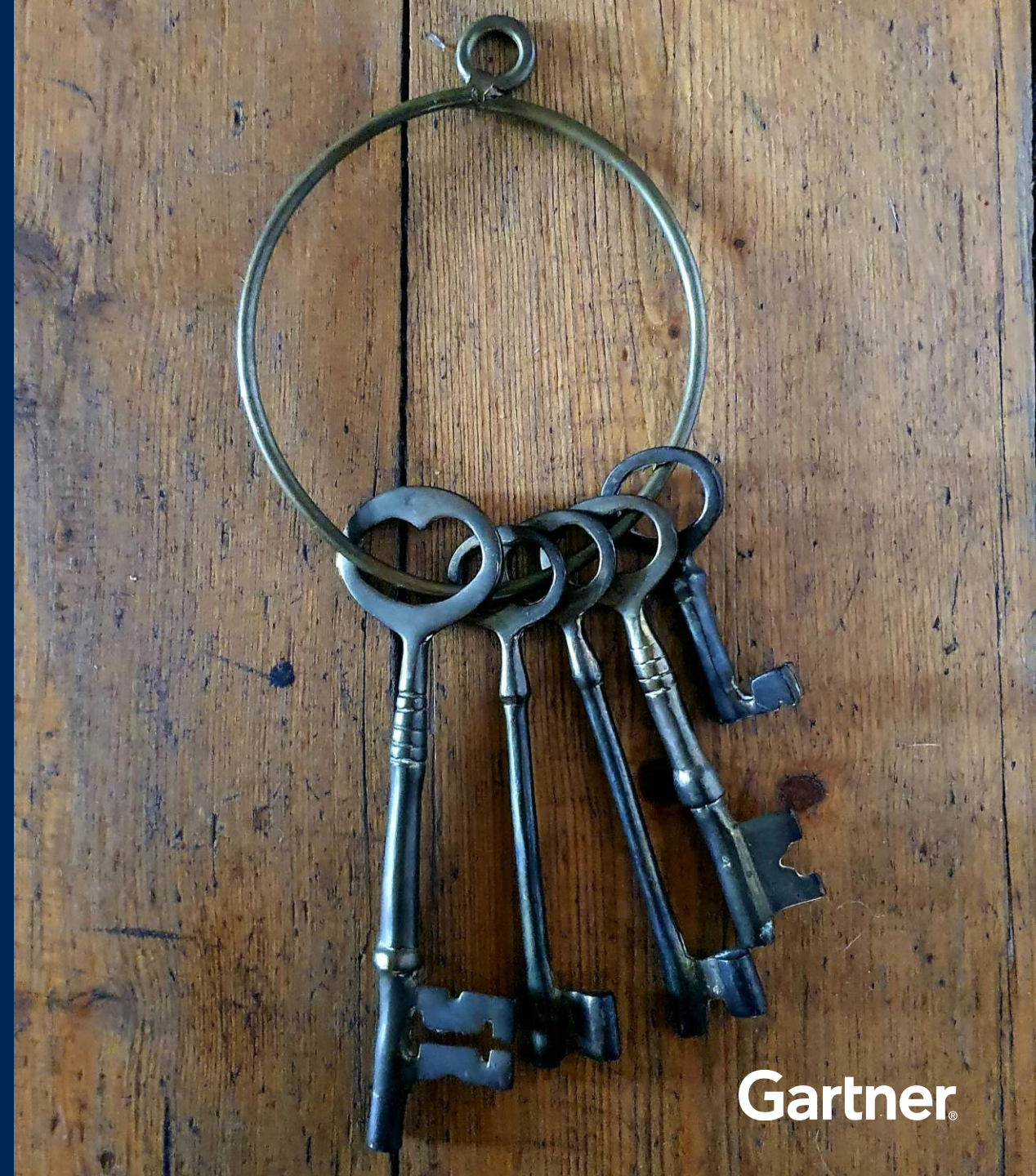
Paul Mezzera

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**Standing privileges
are like master keys
that are always
available —**

**even when they're
not needed.**



JIT access is essential for reducing the attack surface in your environment.



Agenda

1

**Why is JIT
access and just-
enough privilege
(JEP) important?**

2

**How do we reduce
risk applying
a JIT and JEP
approach?**

3

**What tooling
is available to
implement JIT and
JEP approaches?**

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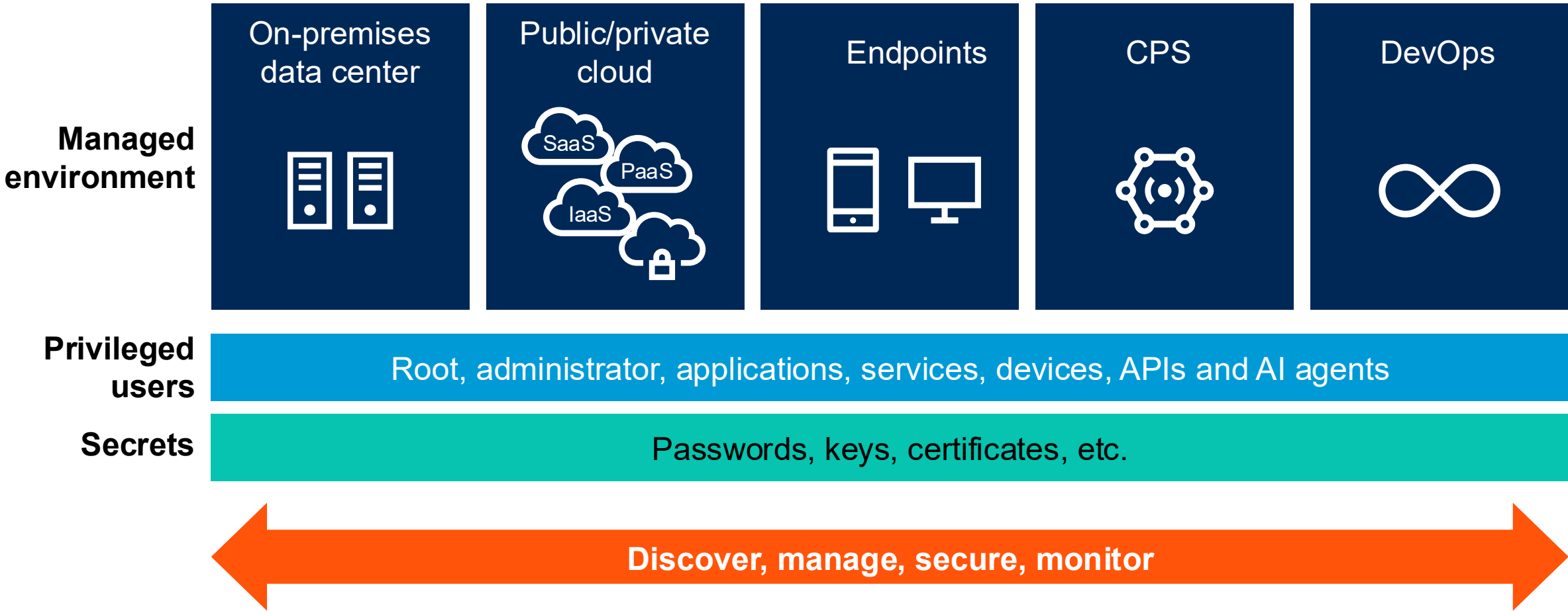
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PAM Has a Large and Increasing Scope

Privileged Access Management Across a Hybrid IT Enterprise



Privileged Admins Have Excessive Entitlements



More than 95% of identities use less than 3% of cloud entitlements that they are granted which greatly increases the attack surface for account compromises.



Overprivileged accounts are one of the top 3 most concerning machine identity threats.



26% of organizations believe that over 50% of their service accounts are overprivileged.

Standing Privileges Increase Risk



**Creates a
larger and
continuous
attack surface**



**Increases
likelihood of
intentional or
unintentional
misuse**



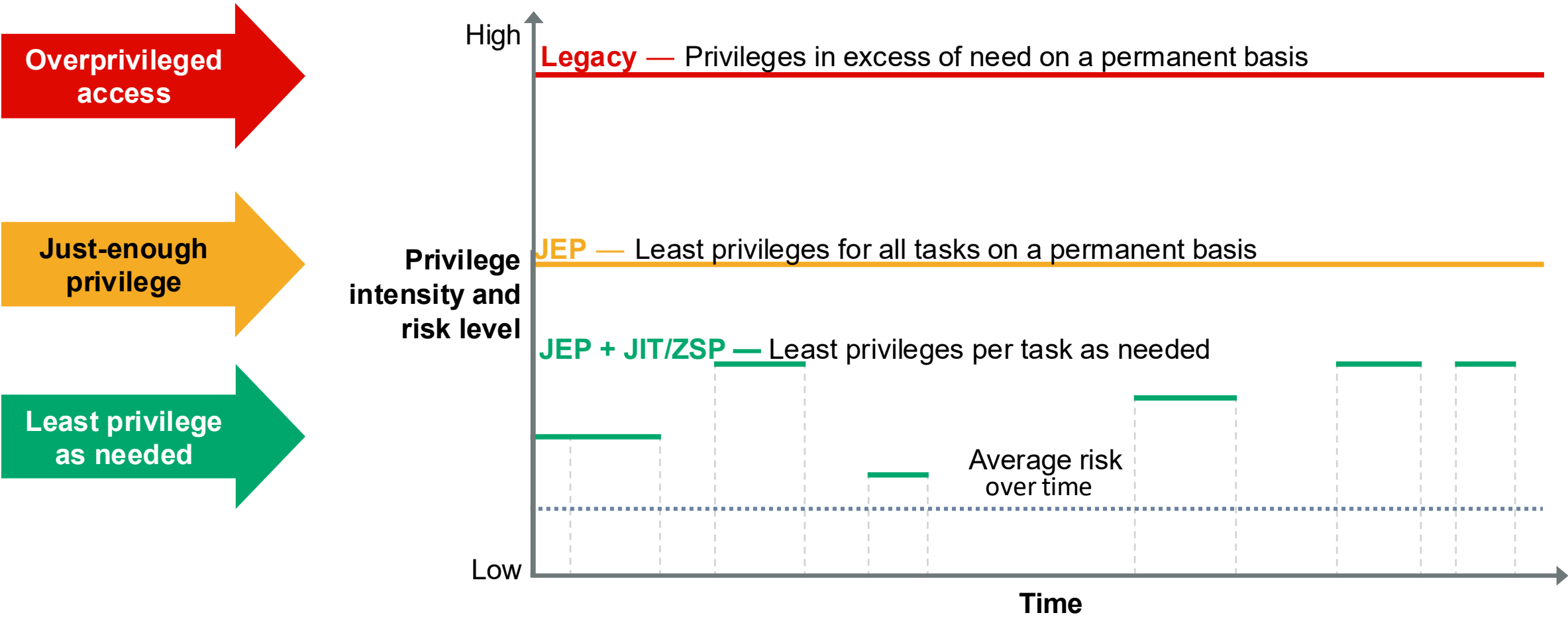
**Leads to
a lack of
accountability
and auditability**



**Delays
detection
of malicious
activity**

Standing and Excessive Privileges Means Greater Risk

Reduce Risk Through JEP and JIT/ZSP



Source: Gartner

JEP = Just-enough privilege; JIT = Just-in-time



JIT reduces risk of *standing* privileges while JEP reduces risk of *excessive* privileges.

You need both.

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Reduce Attack Surface by Reducing Unnecessary Privileges



Leverage the capabilities of a PAM tool



Discover where privileged access exists



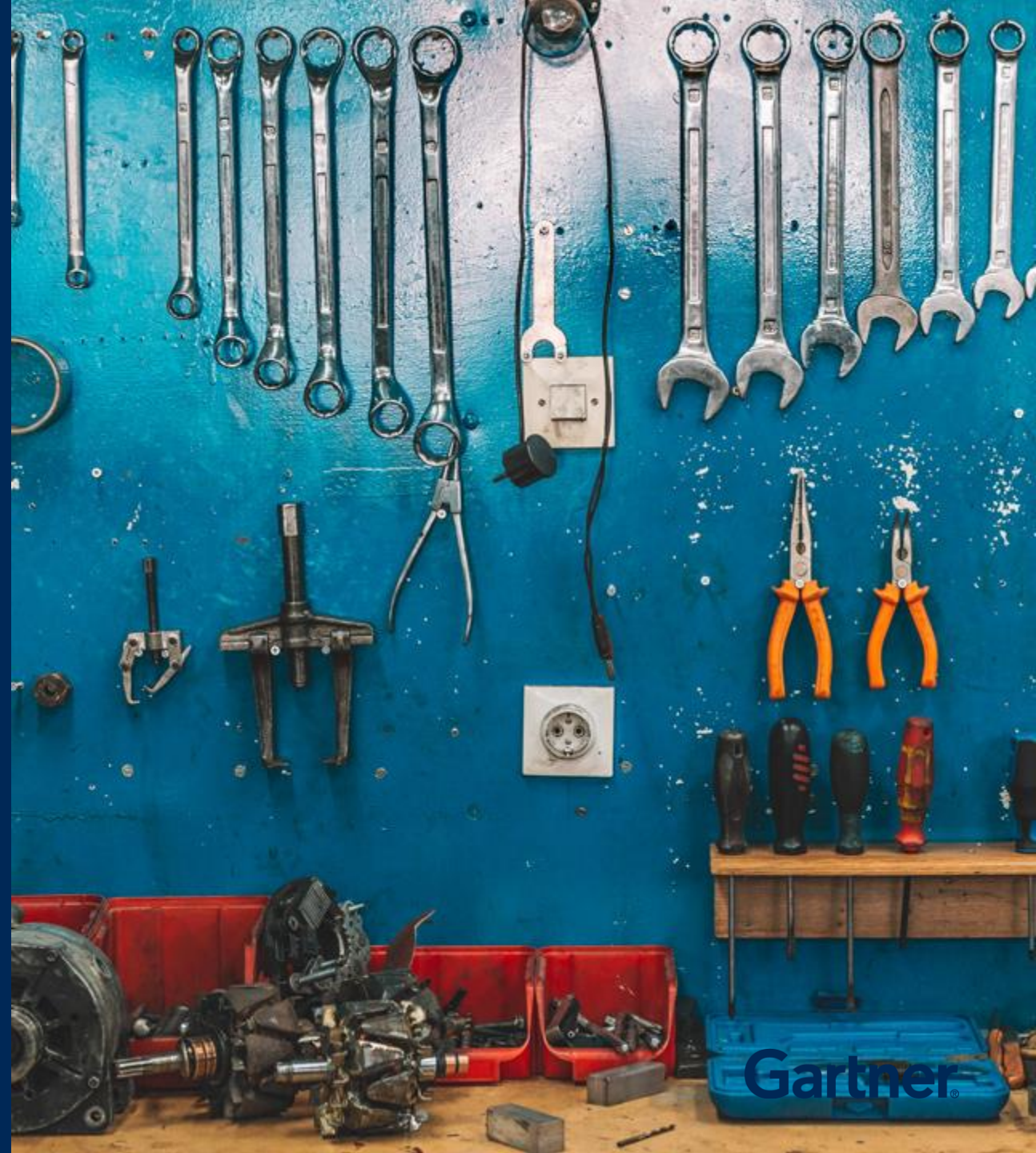
Prioritize account onboarding



Reduce the scope of privileged accounts

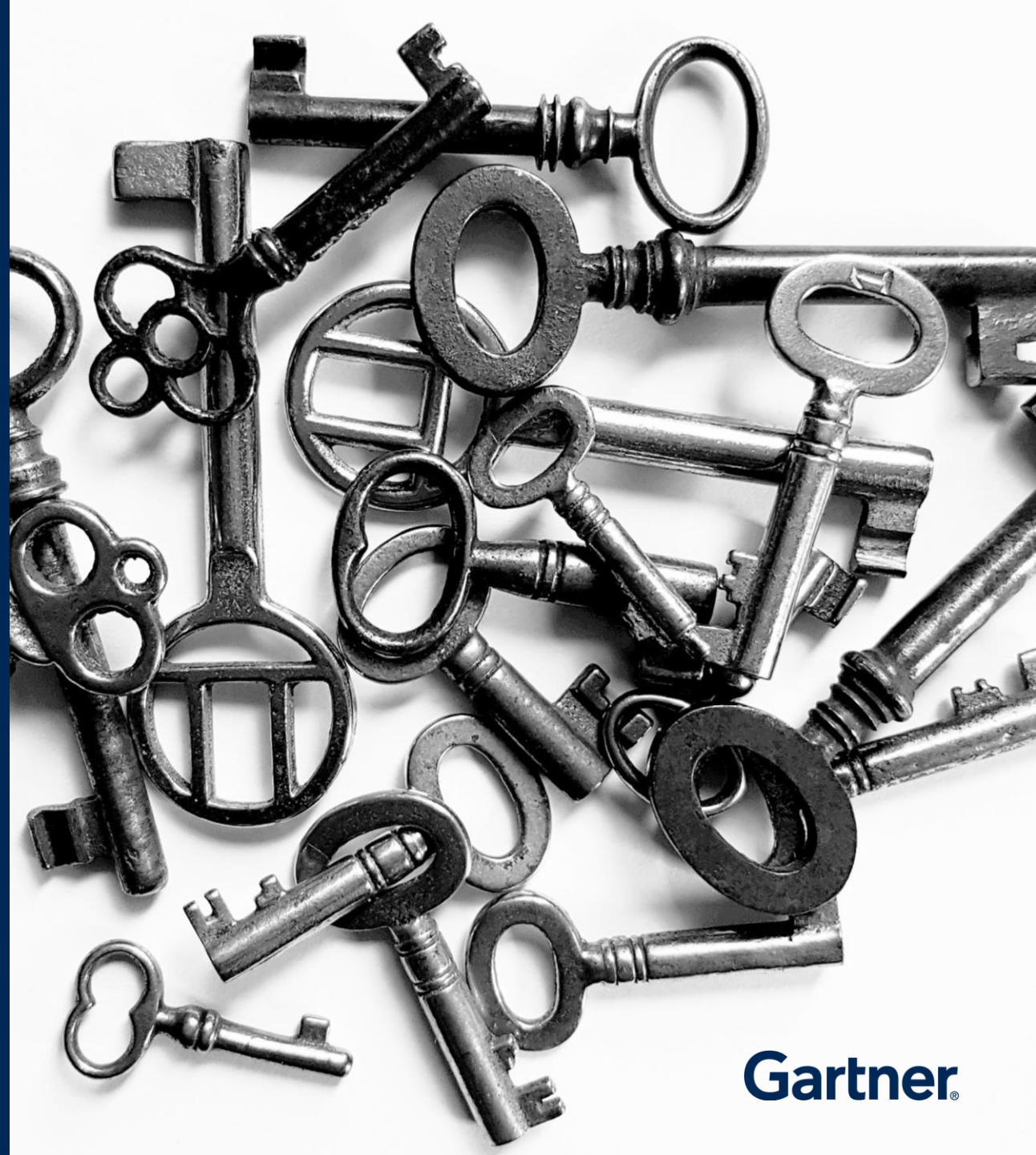
Leverage a PAM Tool

- Continuous discovery of new accounts
- Vaulting and management of accounts and credentials
- Securing and auditing of privileged activities
- Tracking usage



Discover Privileged Access — Bottom Up

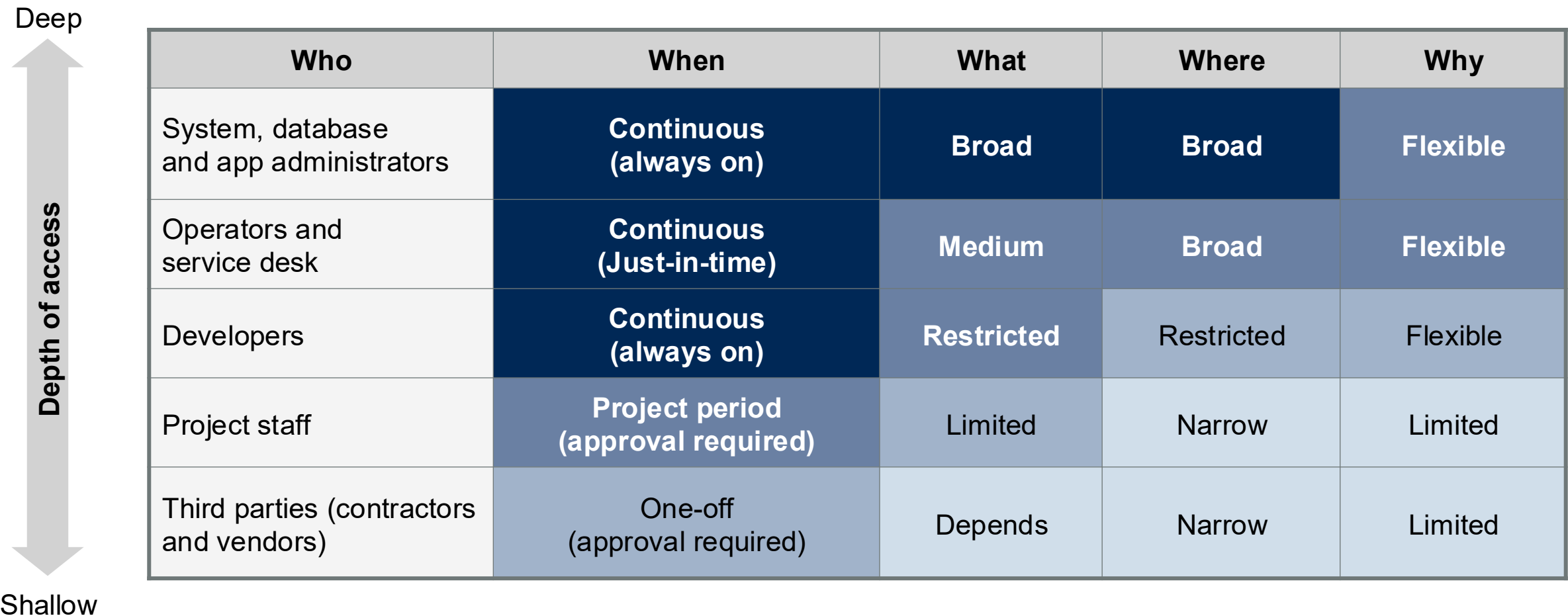
- CMDB systems
- PAM discovery tools
- IGA/CIEM tools
- SIEM logs
- Legwork



Discover Privileged Access — Top Down

The Five Ws of Privileged Access

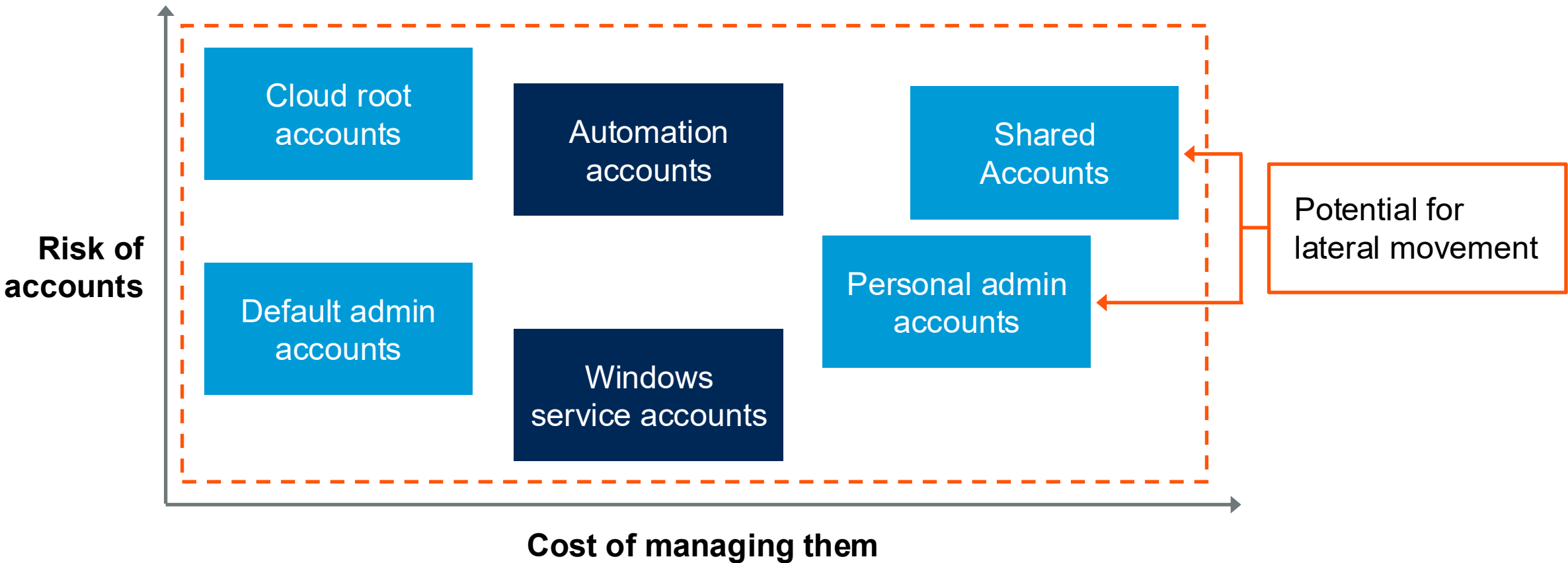
Risk scale: ■ High ■ Medium high ■ Medium ■ Low



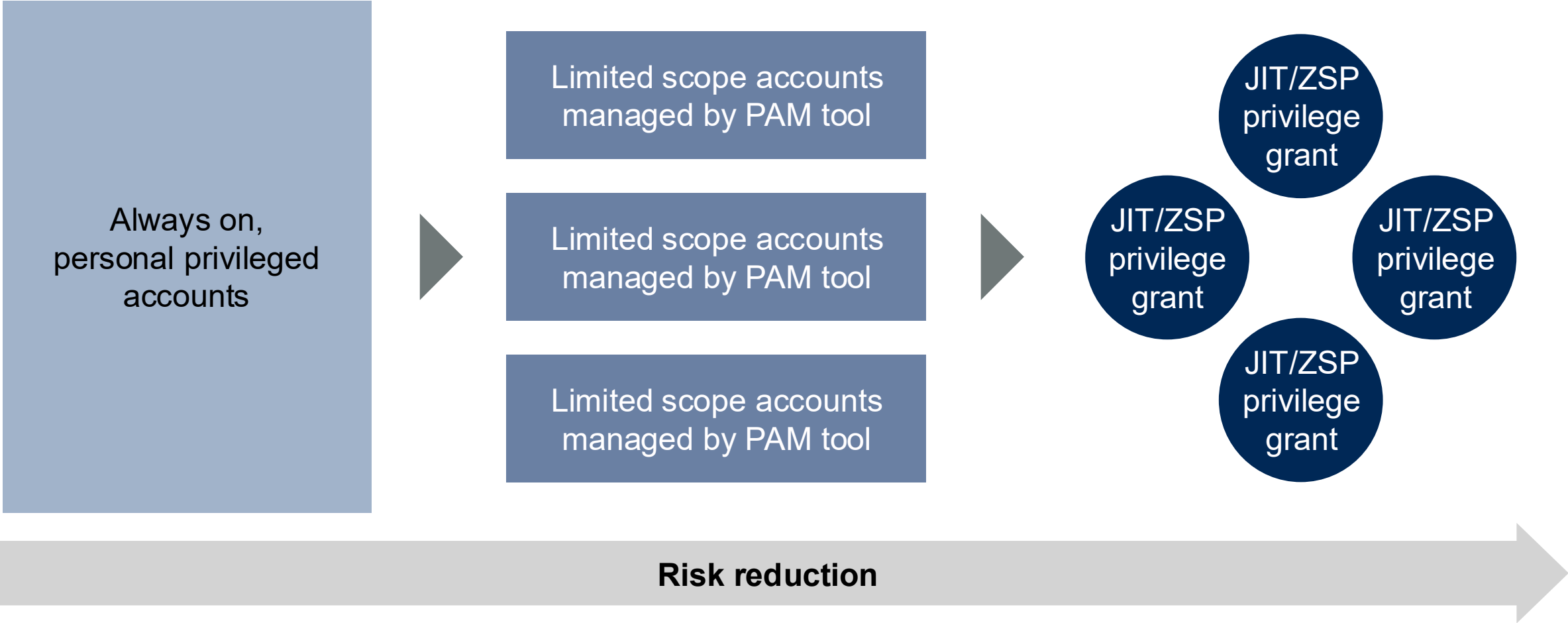
Source: Gartner

Prioritize Onboarding by Understanding Risk Levels

■ Machine Accounts ■ People Accounts



Reduce the Scope of Privileged Accounts



Source: Gartner



Reduce risk by moving from broadly scoped accounts to functional accounts that have a very narrow scope with just enough privileges.

Reduce Attack Surface by Reducing Standing Privileges



Assess the people, process and technology changes required to implement JIT.



Identify and prioritize JIT candidates.



Establish and track success metrics in moving to a JIT approach.

JIT Prerequisites



JIT access request

Processes and workflows to manage privileged access requests and fulfillment.



JIT access mechanisms

Understand the ways you can temporarily elevate a user or machine's access.



JIT access monitoring

The ability to record and monitor all activities performed with the temporary elevated access.

Identify and Prioritize JIT Candidates

-  Target low-complexity use cases with standing privileges.
-  Leverage the five Ws model to identify candidate scenarios.
-  Target infrequent/limited users.
-  Evaluate use cases with clearly defined permissions.
-  Identify routine system changes associated with formal approvals.
-  Identify greenfield environments, such as cloud workloads.
-  Consider cloud infrastructure as another well-suited use case.

Define and Measure Progress in Reducing Risk

Example Metrics

Metric	Current value	Target	Trend (last 6 months)	Status (color)
Standing privileged accounts	12	0	↓ 30%	(At risk)
JIT privilege grant rate	82%	95%	↑ 10%	(Improving)
Average privilege duration	45 min	<15 min	↓ 20%	(Needs work)
Privileged access usage frequency	3/user/mo	<1/mo	↓ 15%	(Improving)
Orphaned privileged accounts	2	0	↓ 50%	(At risk)
Audit log completeness	98%	100%	↑ 2%	(Good)
Incident rate (privileged accounts)	1/qtr	0	↓ 50%	(Improving)
Compliance findings (privileges)	1/yr	0	↓ 75%	(Good)



Plan to invest resources in the people and the process, in addition to the technology required to implement a JIT approach.

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Why is JIT access and just-enough privilege (JEP) important?

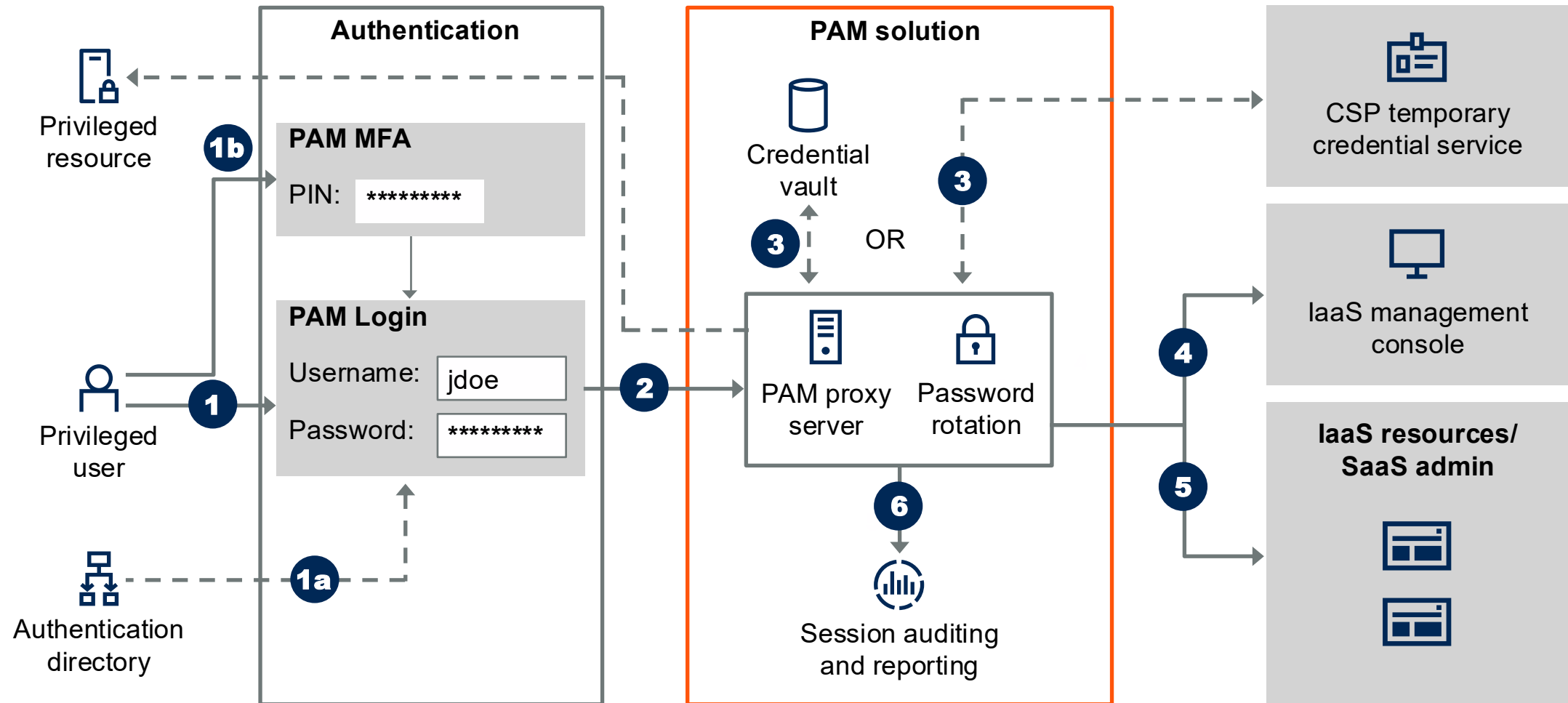
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How do we reduce risk applying a JIT and JEP approach?

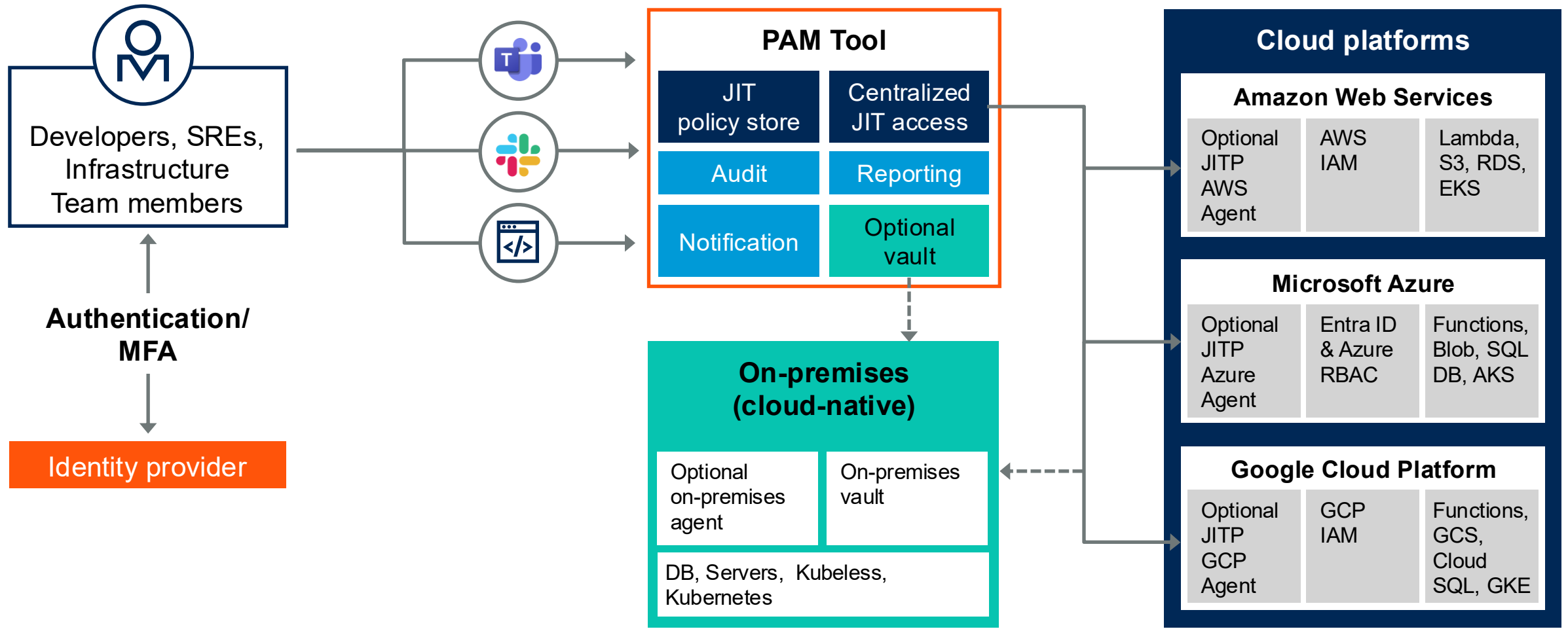
3

What tooling is available to implement JIT and JEP approaches?

Traditional PAM Tools



Just-in-Time Privilege (JITP) Tools



JITP Tools — Pros and Cons

JITP stand-alone tools offer coverage to specific use cases in the cloud.

They vary widely, but majority of them do the following:



Secure
access to cloud
infrastructure



Better UX
for developers
and engineers



Act as silos and not
integrate with your
existing PAM/IAM



Offer limited
privileged
access reviews

Example Vendor Landscape

PAM vendors (MQ)

- ARCON
- BeyondTrust
- CyberArk
- Delinea
- Keeper Security
- ManageEngine
- Netwrix
- One Identity
- Saviynt
- Segura
- StrongDM*
- WALLIX

Other PAM vendors

- Bravura Security
- Britive
- Fortinet
- HashiCorp
- Microsoft
- Okta
- Xage Security

JITP specialty vendors

- Andromeda
- Apono
- P0 Security
- SSH
- Teleport



Depending on whether you have a PAM tool that can support required JIT scenarios, it may be necessary to acquire a specialized JITP tool.

Recommendations

- ④ Start with discovery and onboarding privileged accounts and then work toward reducing excessive privileges and enabling JIT.
- ④ Recognize that efforts to reduce excessive and standing privileges is an ongoing process. It is a long-term journey!
- ④ Define success metrics that can demonstrate progress to your key stakeholders. Many PAM tools provide dashboards and reports that can measure progress of your JIT/JEP efforts.
- ④ As you acquire or refresh your PAM capabilities, prioritize JIT and JEP capabilities as essential features.

Recommended Gartner Insights

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- 🔍 [Reduce Risk Through a Just-In-Time Approach to PAM](#)
Paul Mezzera, Nayara Sangiorgio and Others
- 🔍 [IAM Leaders’ Guide to Privileged Access Management](#)
Abhyuday Data, Felix Gaehtgens and Others
- 🔍 [Magic Quadrant for Privileged Access Management](#)
Abhyuday Data, Paul Mezzera and Others
- 🔍 [Critical Capabilities for Privileged Access Management](#)
Paul Mezzera, Abhyuday Data and Others
- 🔍 [Empower Your Engineering Teams With Privileged Infrastructure Access](#)
Nat Krishnan